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“We’ve accomplished what we set out to accomplish,” said D.C. Mayor Muriel E. Bowser (D), shown in September at the Capitol.

D.C.’s Bowser won’t seek fourth term

BY MEAGAN FLYNN,
JONATHAN O’CONNELL
AND JENNY GATHRIGHT

D.C. Mayor Muriel E. Bowser (D) will not seek reelection, a seismic decision in D.C. politics that will bring to a close more than a decade in leadership overseeing some of the city’s most booming times and also its most turbulent crises this century.

In an interview Monday night with The Washington Post, Bowser, 53, said that “we’ve accom-

TEES UP A COMPETITIVE 2026 MAYORAL RACE

Decision comes as city faces major challenges ahead

plished what we set out to accomplish.” After securing one of her latest wins — a deal to build a new NFL stadium — she said she determined it was time to step aside.

“I think I had to answer the question, if I’m the only one that can do it. And no, I’m not the only one that could do it,” she said.

Bowser’s decision to step aside, announced publicly Tuesday, opens up what is bound to be a highly competitive mayor’s race at a high-stakes moment for D.C., with President Donald Trump in the White House and an aggressive Republican-controlled Congress eager to impose its policy

vision on the liberal city.

Bowser declined to say whether she will endorse a candidate to succeed her or what she plans to do when she leaves office in January 2027. “We will have other candidates that will have ideas about how to do it, and D.C. voters will pick the right one,” she said.

Speaking directly to residents in a video she released Tuesday, Bowser called it “the honor of my life to be your mayor.”

“When you placed your trust in
SEE BOWSER ON A8

Trump zeal belies gap in Ukraine peace talks

President cites progress, but Moscow and Kyiv differ on territory issues

This article is by Robyn Dixon, Michael Birnbaum, Siobhán O’Grady, Francesca Ebel and Catherine Belton

President Donald Trump projected optimism on Tuesday that negotiations to end Russia’s war in Ukraine were making progress, saying there were “only a few remaining points of disagreement” after a week of breakneck talks, but he said he would meet with the leaders of the warring countries only once they were in the final phases of a deal.

The decision to push off a meeting with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky dashed Kyiv’s hopes that the Ukrainian leader could use a one-on-one meeting with Trump in the coming days to reset the dynamic of negotiations that many Ukrainians feel have been tipped in Moscow’s favor. A senior Ukrainian official said earlier Tuesday that Zelensky hoped to meet Trump as soon as the Thanksgiving weekend.

Trump’s declaration appeared aimed at spurring both sides into compromise even as the trickiest details of a deal remained unresolved. Ukrainians have said that only Zelensky is empowered to resolve questions about whether to surrender additional Ukrainian territory to Russia, a key Russian demand that remains politically

SEE RUSSIA ON A13

Russian advances: Putin touts tiny gains made at a high cost. **A12**

Spared from the table, ready for his closeup



MARVIN JOSEPH/THE WASHINGTON POST

Waddle turns heads Tuesday at the White House and captivates Niko, son of White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt. At the pardoning event, the president piled scorn onto his rivals. **Story, B1, and photos, A21**

ICE patrols in Chicago delayed FEMA’s aid efforts

BY BRIANNA SACKS

In early November, Illinois and Federal Emergency Management Agency officials pulled dozens of personnel back from surveying flood-damaged neighborhoods in Chicago because immigration agents were conducting patrols nearby, according to messages reviewed by The Washington Post and four people with knowledge

of the situation.

The four individuals, like others interviewed for this story, spoke on the condition of anonymity out of fear of retaliation.

The decision to halt the disaster assessment teams’ work on Nov. 6 came amid an ongoing immigration crackdown in the city, leaving the coordinating state and agency officials worried that FEMA’s efforts could put

residents as well as the surveyors at risk. The shift meant about 10 groups of federal, state, county and local workers had to stop work surveying hundreds of homes that sustained heavy water damage in parts of the city hit hard by recent storms — assessments that help the federal agency document disaster impacts, and can help make a case for why an area may need help paying for

recovery.

Last month, the Trump administration denied the state’s initial request for a disaster declaration meant to help its communities rebound from back-to-back punishing summer storms, concluding there was “insufficient severity,” according to a letter obtained by The Post. Illinois then asked FEMA to conduct additional

SEE ICE ON A19

After building a political machine, how will Ocasio-Cortez use it next?

The congresswoman, an outsider playing the inside game, is considering a run for Senate or president

BY LIZ GOODWIN
AND YASMEEN ABUTALEB

Earlier this year, Rep. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez received an unlikely request: A former colleague who once excoriated her brand of left-wing politics wanted her assistance.

The New York Democrat was happy to help.

She sent out a fall fundraising email calling centrist candidate Abigail Spanberger “a brawler for the working class” — putting her stamp of approval on a former congresswoman who once fumed after a disappointing 2020 election season that she didn’t want Democrats to “use the word ‘socialist’ or ‘socialism’ ever again.” Their mutual embrace — unthinkable just a few

years ago — shows the influence the democratic socialist has amassed in a party that once saw her more as hostile actor than helpful supporter.

The same early November night that Spanberger romped to victory in the Virginia governor’s race, Ocasio-Cortez squeezed her fellow democratic socialist Zohran Mamdani in a tight hug after he was elected mayor of New York, putting an exclamation point on an election season in which she was in high demand across the party spectrum. At his victory party, she made her way from news camera to news camera, telling the establishment Democrats watching that his win — boosted by her early endorsement — had put them on notice.

SEE OCASIO-CORTEZ ON A10

Taps run dry in Iran after decades of bad decisions

BY YEGANEH TORBATI



ABEDIN TAHERKENAREH/EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

The Amir Kabir Dam in northern Iran is seen at low capacity on Nov. 10 amid a severe drought.

A staggering water shortage this year is throwing Iran’s future livability into question, with dozens of dams close to empty, residents of Tehran facing the possibility of running out of water within weeks and the president even floating the idea of evacuating the capital, though it is unclear where those millions of people would go.

A historic lack of rain and an ongoing five-year drought have helped bring Iran to the brink. But the current crisis has its roots in high-level policy decisions taken over the decades to bolster the country’s agriculture, including with intensive irrigation, to make Iran largely self-sufficient in food — at the cost of nearly all of the country’s precious water resources.

Iran’s government has guaranteed the purchase of certain
SEE IRAN ON A15

IN THE NEWS

Out of appeals Brazil’s Supreme Court ruled that former president Jair Bolsonaro must begin his 27-year prison sentence for plotting a coup after his 2022 election loss. **A7**

A child who bore witness Viola Fletcher, the oldest survivor of the Tulsa Race Massacre — a 1921 riot in Oklahoma — was III. **B13**

THE NATION Researchers found a potential link between sleep apnea and Parkinson’s disease. **A2**
Michelle Obama said the East Wing’s demolition was “a loss for us as a nation.” **A5**

THE WORLD A top **E.U. court** ruled that all member states must honor same-sex marriages. **A13**
China views a pair of Trump phone calls as wins in its spat with Japan over Taiwan. **A14**

THE ECONOMY Technology is revolutionizing the job of the U.S. farmer, making some labor obsolete and creating new careers for younger workers. **A16**
A fired worker’s lawsuit claims retaliation over reporting a Campbell’s executive’s racist, profanity-filled rant. **A16**

STYLE “Hamnet,” a film about William Shakespeare and his wife, is as beautiful as it is gut-wrenching. **B1**

SPORTS At **17-1**, the defending champion Oklahoma City Thunder looks capable of joining the NBA’s 70-win club. **B7**

THE REGION A **House** committee is investigating Fairfax County Public Schools, Virginia’s largest school district, for alleged antisemitism. **B12**
Maryland has removed foster children from hotels following a teen’s death, shifting a decades-old policy. **B12**

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